

Psalms 150

Praise Him with Instruments

Let every thing that hath breath praise the Lord. Praise ye the Lord
KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 Praise ye the LORD. Praise God in his sanctuary: praise him in the firmament of his power.
- 2 Praise him for his mighty acts: praise him according to his excellent greatness.
- 3 Praise him with the sound of the trumpet: praise him with the psaltery and harp.
- 4 Praise him with the timbrel and dance: praise him with stringed instruments and organs.
- 5 Praise him upon the loud cymbals: praise him upon the high sounding cymbals.
- 6 Let every thing that hath breath praise the LORD. Praise ye the LORD.

2 · CONTEXT

The Psalter's final psalm is a pure, unqualified crescendo of praise—no lament, no petition, no complaint, only an escalating call to worship with every available instrument, in every possible location, by every living thing. Its structure functions as a fitting close to the entire book: whatever struggles, questions, and unresolved tensions have filled the preceding hundred and forty-nine psalms, the collection ends simply in total, unrestrained praise. Henry treats it as the Psalter's intended destination—all roads of honest lament and petition eventually leading here.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-2

Praise is called for in God's sanctuary and in the firmament of His power, grounded in His mighty acts and His excellent greatness—worship located both in a specific place and stretched across the whole visible sky.

Verse 3-5

A cascade of instruments follows: trumpet, lute and harp, timbrel accompanied by dance, stringed instruments and pipe, loud and high-sounding cymbals—nearly every instrument available to ancient worship named in quick succession, holding nothing back.

Verse 6

The psalm, and the entire Psalter, closes with the widest possible summons: let everything that has breath praise the Lord. No qualification, exception, or condition is attached—only an unrestricted final call to praise.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

After a Psalter full of lament, doubt, anger, confession, and petition, the book deliberately ends not with resolution to any single struggle but with total, unqualified praise—suggesting that praise is where all honest engagement with God is ultimately meant to arrive. The psalm's escalating list of instruments and its final, breath-wide summons refuse to limit worship to any single mood, method, or category of person.

Application for life today.

Let this psalm's placement as the Psalter's ending shape your own expectation: even seasons of lament or unresolved struggle are meant to move, eventually, toward praise rather than remain permanently stuck. Consider whether your own worship has narrowed to a single mode, and take the psalm's cascade of instruments as encouragement to praise with whatever expressions—physical, musical, or otherwise—are available to you. Take verse 6 personally and literally: as long as you have breath, let praising God be your simple, unqualified default.

5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. How does the Psalter's decision to end in unqualified praise, after so many chapters of lament and struggle, shape your own expectation for where a hard season should eventually lead?

2. Has your own worship narrowed to a single mode or feeling, and what would it look like to praise God with the range and energy this psalm describes?

3. What would change in your daily life if you took verse 6 literally—that as long as you have breath, praising God is your basic, unqualified calling?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, *Commentary on the Whole Bible* (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).